

When is expensive perception worth paying for?

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ONE RECORDED RUN PER VIEW · NOTHING ON THIS SCREEN IS LIVE

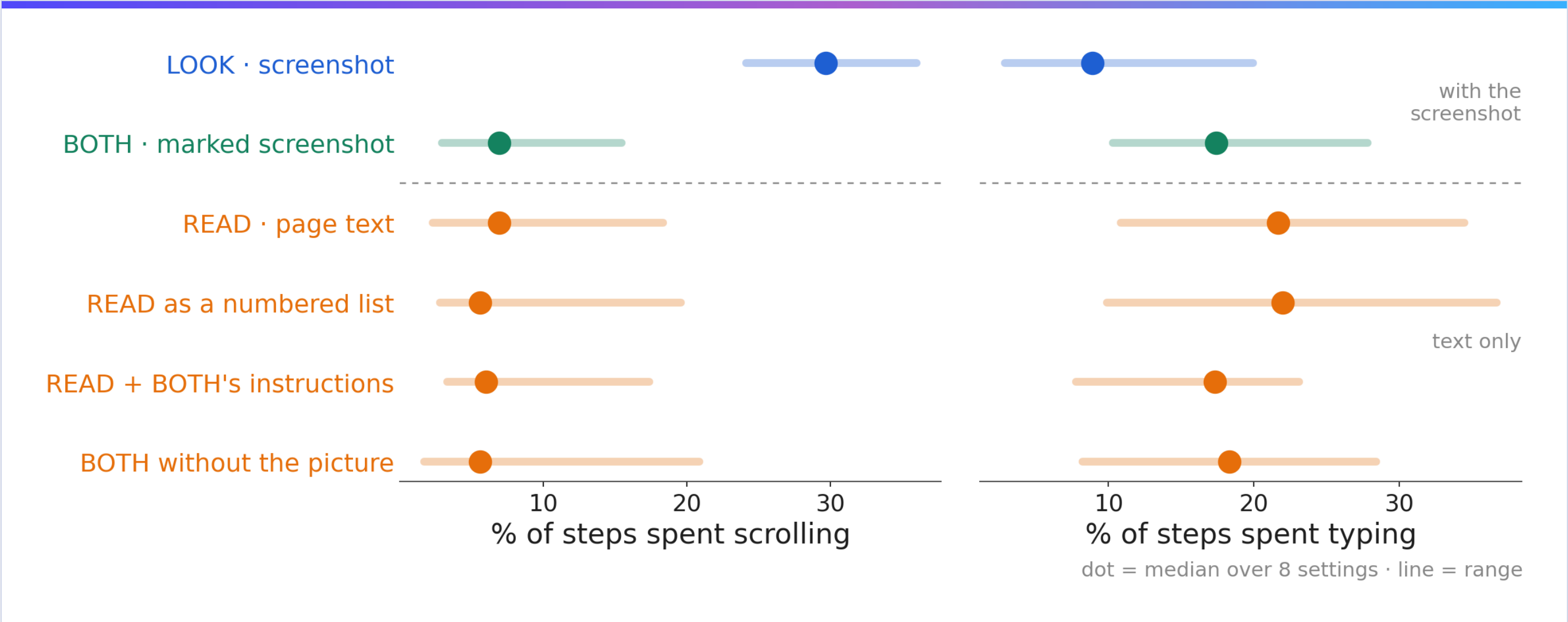
■ Same task, three ways of seeing it, three different bills.

IF YOU BUILD A WEB AGENT

Should it look, read, or both — and can it learn to choose?

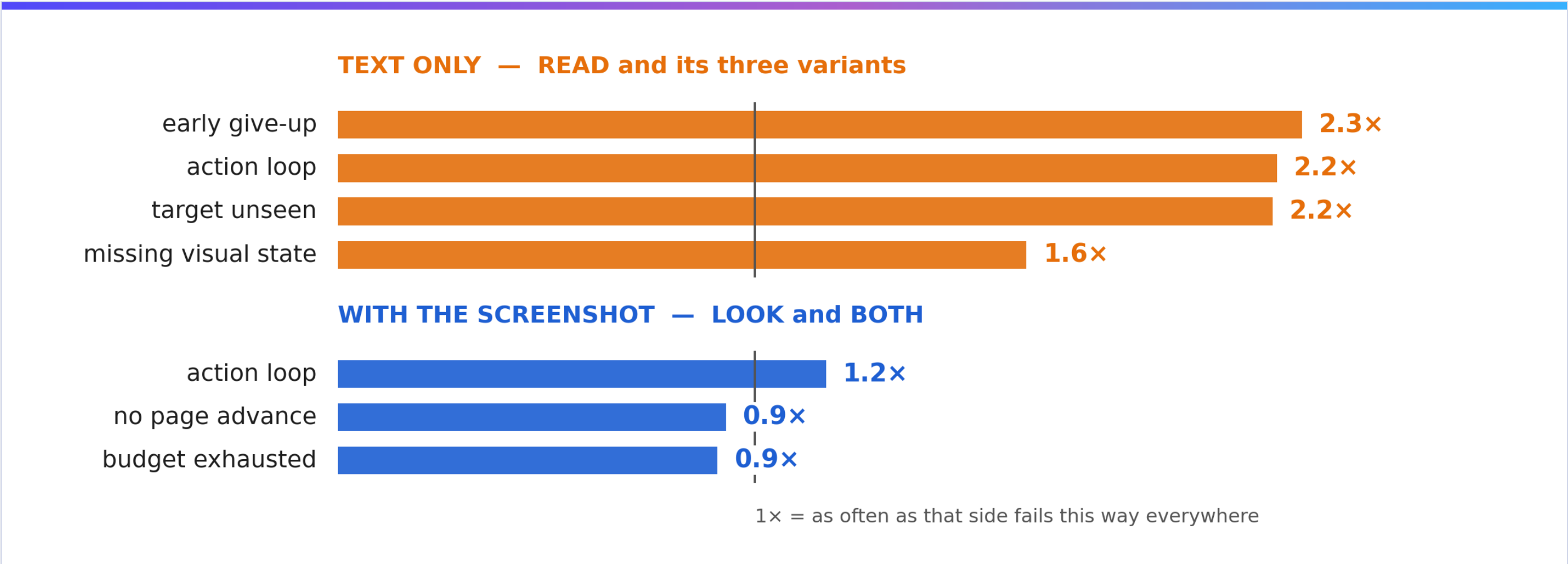
- 1 How do the views behave?
- 2 How do they fail?
- 3 Does choosing pay?
- 4 Can it be learned?

■ With only the screenshot, the agent scrolls far more and types far less.



Medians over 8 settings: LOOK scrolls in **about 30%** of its steps, every other view **about 6%**; it types about half as often

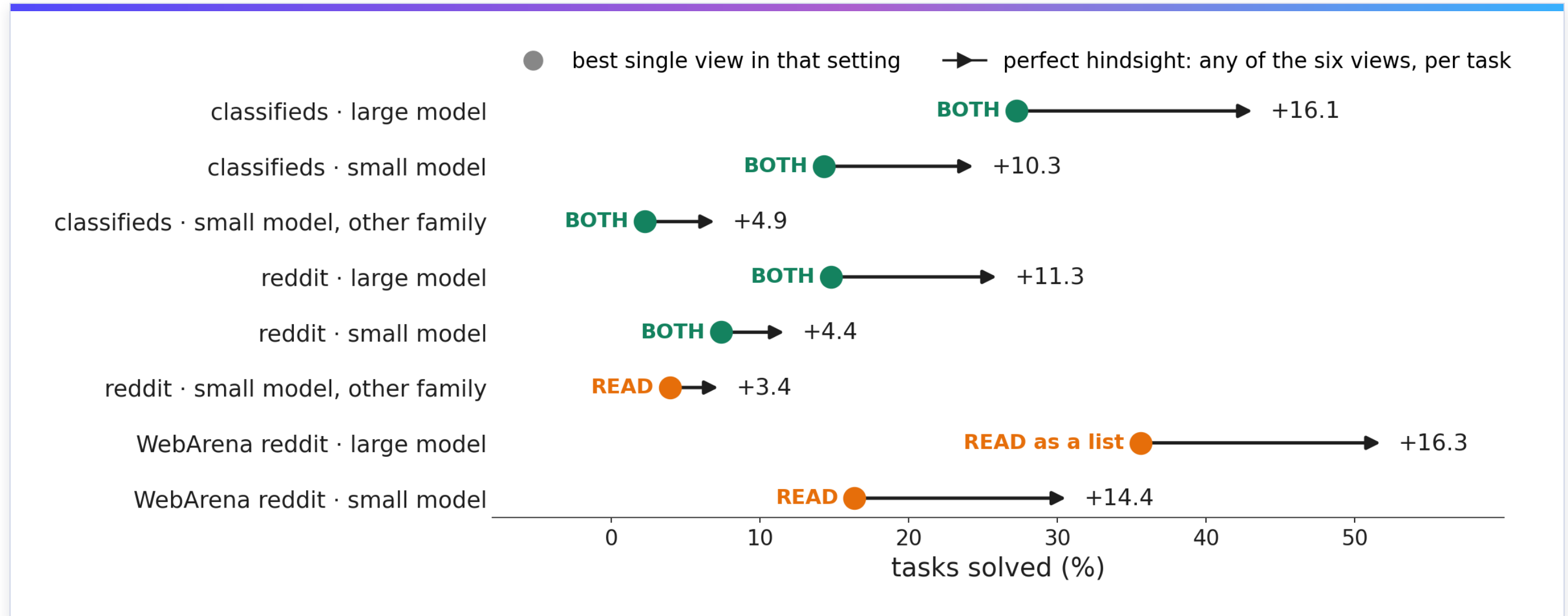
■ Text-only views fail in ways you can name; views with the screenshot just never get there.



Each side vs its own failures elsewhere · text-only: several over **2x** · LOOK and BOTH: none stands out · six VisualWebArena settings

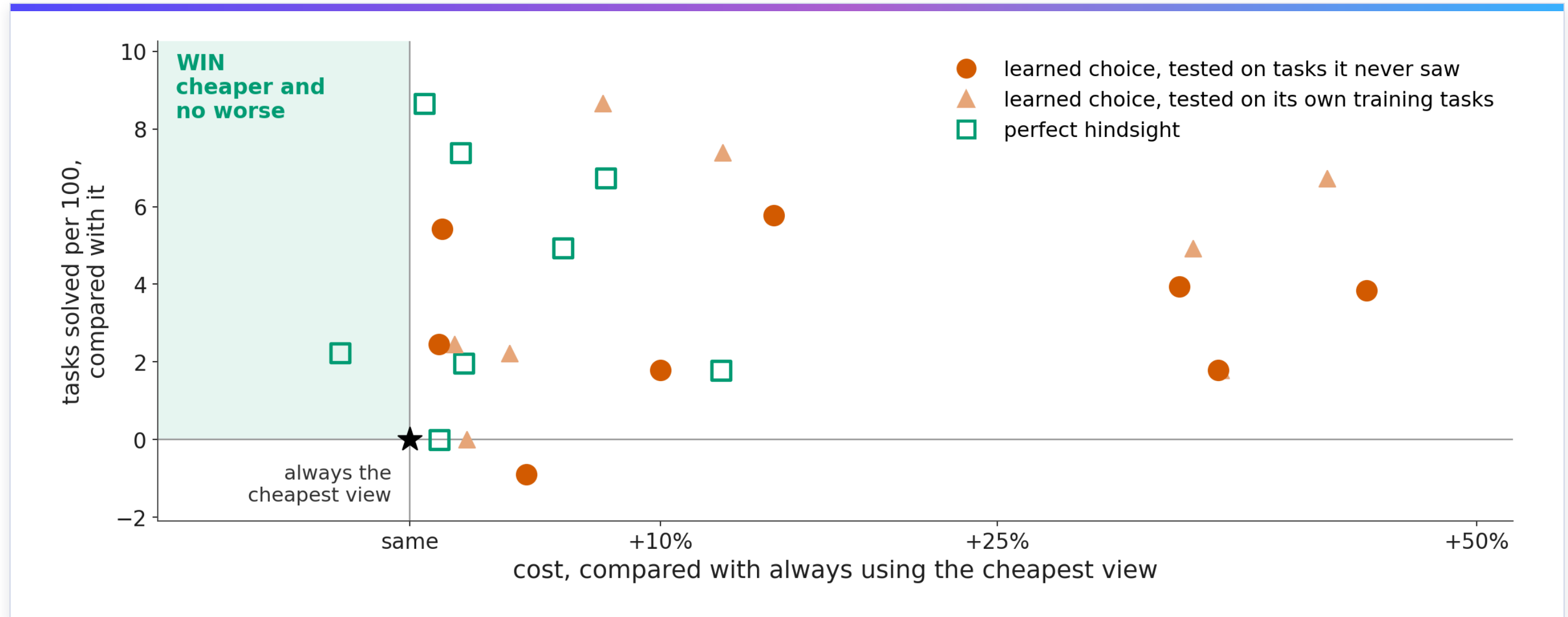
③ DOES CHOOSING PAY

■ Hindsight says choosing pays; a rerun says how much of that is noise.



Perfect hindsight: **+3.45 to +16.35** in 100 · in the one setting rerun for every view, one more view bought **+7.14**, one rerun **+4.46 to +7.59**

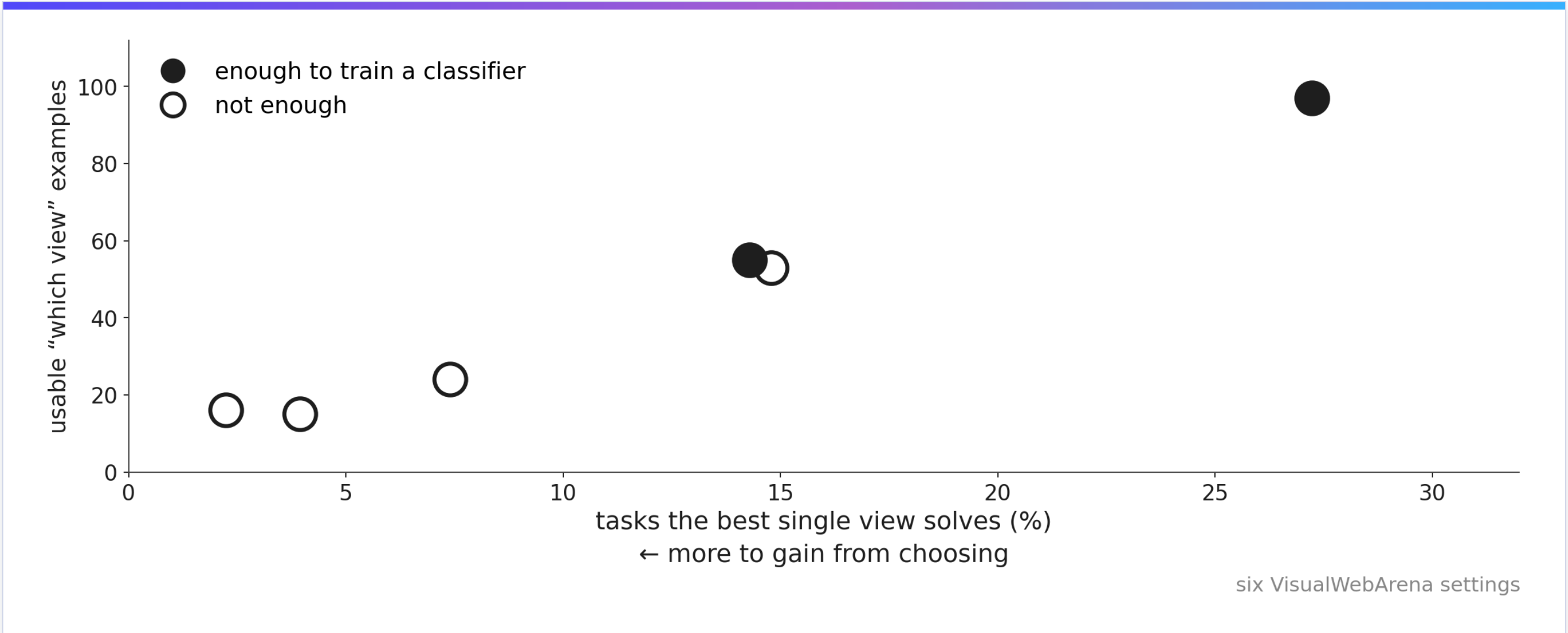
Learned routers buy success only by spending more.



Win region = cheaper and no worse. Learned: **0 of 8**. Perfect hindsight: **1 of 8**.

WHY NOT YET · A “WHICH VIEW” EXAMPLE EXISTS ONLY WHEN THE TASK IS SOLVED

More routing upside, less usable training signal.



Base success **2–36%** · **15–97** usable examples per setting · enough to train in **2 of the 6**

NOT YET

■ Improve the agent first, collect reliable examples, then learn when to look.

WHAT IT TAKES

- a stronger agent
- failing settings: at least **2.1–4.2×** more tasks
- reruns that agree

THREE ASKS

- ✓ type a task at the board
- ✓ which view do you use?
- ✓ lend us a stronger agent

Look, read, or both?
It depends on the task.
Nothing we trained knows it yet.



Come to the board — try your own task, live in all three views.

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REFERENCE – TASK 130, RECORDED STEPPING, 39 S